

Building New-age Businesses

From defence electronics and drones to quick home services, women leaders are helping build India's next-generation businesses and showing why scaling a company takes more than just a breakthrough idea

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**

ACROSS INDIA'S NEW-AGE INDUSTRIES, women are taking on leadership roles in businesses that are reshaping how people shop, access services, use technology or secure the country. From eyewear and genomics to quick commerce, drones and defence electronics, they are helping build companies in markets where the challenge is not merely to develop a promising idea but to turn it into a business that can grow and endure.

Their journeys are taking different forms. Neha Bansal, co-founder of Lenskart, has built a technology-led eyewear business spanning online and offline; Nandita Sinha, who previously led Myntra, took charge of Swiggy's quick-commerce business Instamart in August 2026; Anuradha Acharya, founder and CEO of Mapmygenome, has brought personal genomics closer to consumers; and Rekha Murthy Rangarajan has built processes and manufacturing capabilities of defence electronics company Data Patterns. Alongside them are Anjali Sardana, founder of home-services platform Pronto; Rithika Mohan, co-founder and chief administrative officer of drone-maker Garuda Aerospace; and Shilpa Choudari, whose career at defence-technology company Zen Technologies evolved from research and marketing support into finance and operations.